



Short take-off

Small planes only need short runways. This means they can go to places where larger planes could not land, such as this grassy airstrip on a mountainside in Nepal.

This plane can seat up to 19 passengers.

The rudder moves the plane to the left or the right.

This tailplane keeps the plane stable. Hinged flaps on the back of it move up and down to make the plane climb or dive.

This twin-engined "Otter" can take off and land in a small space.

Fighting flames

This Canadair plane is specifically designed for fighting forest fires.

The pilot prepares to lower two pipes to scoop up water into the body of the plane.

Flying slowly and quite low, the pilot opens a hatch to release the water.

As the plane skims the surface, up to 1,400 gallons (6,400 liters) of water are forced into the tanks in 10 seconds.

War and peace

Over the years, there have been many types of propeller-driven aircraft.



World War I triplane



World War II Spitfire



Cessna light plane



Floatplane

